

REPORT of the Citizens' Forum on the vote of 18.6.2023 (Referendum LOCLi)

This report was drawn up by the "demoscan" Citizens' Forum, an **independent group of 20 citizens** selected by drawing lots from all the people residing in the municipality of Bellinzona. The Forum reflected the population according to the following criteria: age, sex, level of education, positioning on the left-right axis and voting frequency. Over the course of four days, the Forum heard from representatives of political parties who support or reject the **Federal Act on Climate Protection Objectives, Innovation and the Strengthening of Energy Security (LOCLi)**, as well as independent experts. The members of the Forum then analysed the information received and deliberated among themselves. The report is sent to all eligible voters in the municipality of Bellinzona, in order to help them form an opinion and participate in the federal vote on the referendum on the LOCLi which will take place on **18 June 2023**.

It is a project carried out by a research group of the University of Geneva with the support of the Swiss National Science Foundation and the City of Bellinzona. The content of the report does not bind the City of Bellinzona or other state bodies. More information: www.demoscan.ch

General Information Select from the City Forum as the most important information that voters should know to get an idea of LOCLi. 1. Greenhouse gas emissions, and CO₂ emissions in particular, are falling too slowly in Switzerland. In order to comply with the 2015 Paris Agreement (in which the signatory countries, including Switzerland, commit to reducing emissions), the law provides for a reduction in greenhouse gases by 2050, in particular by 100% in buildings and transport, and by 90% in industry compared to 1990 values. 2. Scientific studies envisage two reference climate scenarios projected to 2085: the first predicts a temperature increase of between 4°C and 8°C if there is no reduction in the current level of CO₂ emissions. The second envisages a reduction in CO₂ emissions to 1990 levels with a consequent increase in temperatures of between 0.5°C and 2°C. 3. To replace fossil fuels, one of the main causes of CO₂ emissions, renewable energies (hydroelectric, photovoltaic, wind) will have to be further strengthened in order to meet Switzerland's energy needs, taking into account the conformation and protection of our territory. 4. In order to achieve the goal of reducing greenhouse gas emissions by 2050, the law provides for the promotion and use of innovative technologies and processes, as well as the provision of "carbon sinks" (natural or artificial repositories in which CO₂ is stored) in Switzerland and abroad. 5. The Confederation provides a commitment credit for a period of 6 years. This credit is intended to finance companies that propose innovative projects aimed at reducing CO₂ emissions to zero by 2050. 6. The Confederation pays a total contribution of CHF 200 million per year for 10 years (a total of CHF 2 billion). This contribution will be paid to each canton in proportion to its population, for the replacement of old heating systems. 7. The Confederation and the cantons are taking an exemplary role in reducing emissions. In particular, the Federal Administration (e.g. in the renovation of public buildings, in mobility) expects to reach zero balance by 2040. The Federal Council's task with regard to this objective will be to monitor its implementation and report regularly to Parliament. 8. This law does not refer to the introduction of new taxes (e.g. on the cost of airline tickets).

Arguments in favor of the law According to the City Forum, these are the most important topics that voters should know if they want to accept the LOCLi.

1. Information. Action must be taken now to prevent climate change from worsening and to comply with the 2015 Paris Agreement, which Switzerland has also signed, as the measures applied so far have not been sufficient.

This is relevant because: the warming of the climate, mainly caused by greenhouse gas emissions, is clearly recognizable. Weather events such as heat waves, dry spells and heavy rainfall

are on the rise.

2. Information. Replacing fossil fuels (oil, gas and coal) requires an increase in energy production from renewable sources within Switzerland.

This is relevant because: it would allow us to be more independent from abroad (in particular from the import of oil, gas and coal), to invest within our country and to have better stability of energy costs.

3. Information: According to the 2050+ prospective study (source: Swiss Federal Office of Energy, 2022), renewable energy supplies can cover Switzerland's needs.

This is relevant because: the energy transition to renewable energy is possible, considering an ever-increasing efficiency in consumption (e.g. in buildings, in mobility).

IN SUMMARY: The climate situation is very delicate, so we need to act now. The application of new technologies based on renewable energy/sources is necessary; according to the study by the Swiss Federal Office of Energy, this transition is also possible in Switzerland. Thanks to the approval of this law, we would make our country more autonomous from third countries and consequently we would have greater stability in energy costs.

Arguments against the law According to the Forum, these are the most important arguments that voters should know if they want to reject the LOCLi.

1. Information. If the law were to pass, we would be faced with an increase in energy costs for citizens and businesses, particularly in relation to the costs of building and operating new energy systems and plants.

This is important because: it affects the economic interests of citizens and companies resident and active in Switzerland.

2. Information. The approval of this law will lead to retraining for some professional categories, for example in construction and in some sectors of industry, while other categories will no longer be necessary (coal, gas and oil supply chain).

This is relevant because: it is important to know that people employed in these fields will have to make an effort to adapt to changes or reintegrate into other professional fields.

3. Information. If the law were to pass, Switzerland would not be able to rely on wind potential.

This is important because: the structure of the Swiss territory does not allow the optimal use of wind energy. Existing wind farms are not achieving the level of electricity production that was expected. The exploitable areas are already used.

IN SUMMARY: The law provides for the gradual abandonment of fossil fuels by 2050. The increase in electricity demand cannot currently be met with renewable sources alone. The transition will have an impact on energy costs for citizens and businesses, as well as on jobs in certain professional and economic sectors.